centre for pediatric emergencies and specialized care

Pilonidal Gips Procedure

What is a pilonidal sinus Gips procedure?

A Gips pilonidal procedure is a minimally invasive surgical technique used to treat pilonidal disease, which often presents as a painful cyst or abscess near the tailbone. The procedure is performed under local anesthesia, usually in under an hour. Here's how it works:

1. **Identification of Pits:** The surgeon identifies the small openings or pits on the skin surface, which are the sources of the pilonidal disease.
2. **Curettage:** Using a small curette, the surgeon cleans out the pits and removes any hair, debris, and infected tissue.
3. **Minimal Incisions:** Small incisions *may* be made to facilitate drainage if an abscess is present, but these are minimal compared to traditional excisions.
4. **Healing:** The wounds are typically left to heal on their own, which reduces the need for extensive suturing and promotes quicker recovery.

What should I expect in the days following the procedure?

- Pain is usually mild for the first few days and can be relieved with Ibuprofen or Acetaminophen (follow the instructions on the bottle.
- Can return to school the next day and can also return to sports and swimming as soon as you feel comfortable.
- May experience some drainage or bleeding for 1-2 weeks; a sanitary pad can be used to avoid dirtying your underwear.
- Full healing can take up to 4 weeks.

What should you do in the days following the procedure?

- **REST**: In the first 24 hours, go home, rest, and avoid strenuous activities. Leave the bandage on.
- **REMOVE BANDAGE:** On the 2nd day post-surgery, remove the bandage.
- **START SOAKING AREA 3 times a day**.
    - Soak the area in warm water (bath tub or Sitz bath) for 15 minutes each time
    - Continue these baths until the holes we made are closed (may take up to 2 weeks)
- **CHECK FOR HAIR**: Have someone inspect the area daily to make sure no hairs are stuck in the wounds. Use a magnifying glass and flashlight if needed. Remove any hairs with tweezers.
- **SHAVE THE AREA**: Keep the area shaved to prevent new hairs from getting in.
- **CONSIDER LASER HAIR REMOVAL**: After the wound heals (one month later), laser hair removal can help prevent the sinus from coming back. You can have it done by your cosmetician (not covered by RAMQ).

What complications should I monitor for?

- There is redness spreading from the cut to nearby skin
- Wound is hurting more than before
- There is pus (yellow/green liquid, sometimes with a bad smell) coming from the wound
- Any of the above with fever (> 38 degrees Celcius)
- Bleeding that you cannot stop with pressure dressing

What do I do if have a wound complication?

Return to Centre UP at the site closest to your home between 8am-8pm; no appointment needed.

If notice something at night, unless major bleeding or severe pain, can come first thing in the AM

*The recommendations provided in this document are based on general knowledge and experience in the field. However, the educational material contained in this document is NOT a substitute for the clinical judgment necessary to address the diverse needs of patients.